

IN THE SENATE

SENATE CONCURRENT RESOLUTION NO. 123

BY STATE AFFAIRS COMMITTEE

A CONCURRENT RESOLUTION

STATING FINDINGS OF THE LEGISLATURE AND SUPPORTING THE 2026 INTERNATIONAL
YEAR OF RANGELANDS AND PASTORALISTS.

Be It Resolved by the Legislature of the State of Idaho:

WHEREAS, rangelands are natural ecosystems in which the native vegetation is predominantly grasses, grass-like plants, forbs, or shrubs that are typically grazed by livestock and wildlife; and

WHEREAS, such ecosystems cover up to 19.8 billion acres of land globally, roughly 54% of Earth's terrestrial surface, which is proportionally mirrored in Idaho; and

WHEREAS, rangelands are economically, socially, and culturally vital to communities across the world as they provide an array of ecological services; and

WHEREAS, the productivity and environmental health of rangelands are critical for the livelihoods and cultures of more than 500 million pastoralists globally; and

WHEREAS, billions more non-pastoralists across the world benefit from these areas through animal products, tourism, wildlife, biodiversity conservation, renewable energy, and other uses and services; and

WHEREAS, pastoralists are stewards of rangelands who raise livestock or semidomesticated animals on rangelands and who may be otherwise known as ranchers, sheepherders, or nomads; and

WHEREAS, pastoralists played a foundational role in Idaho's formation and development and maintain their cornerstone enterprise in Idaho; and

WHEREAS, pastoralism is a dynamic and transformative livelihood linked to the diverse ecosystems, cultures, identities, traditional knowledge, and historical experience of coexisting with nature; and

WHEREAS, through deep knowledge and connection with the land, pastoralists have coupled the health of landscapes with economic prosperity; and

WHEREAS, healthy rangelands are vital for contributing to economic growth, resilient livelihoods, and the sustainable development of pastoralism. However, rangelands and pastoralism are currently facing urgent and different challenges around the world; and

WHEREAS, Idaho's pastoralists contribute directly and indirectly to a variety of experiences in Idaho's rural and urban economies, thereby supporting local families and businesses, reinforcing an Idaho tradition, and sustaining overall vitality in Idaho's communities; and

WHEREAS, recognizing 2026 as the International Year of Rangelands and Pastoralists provides a timely opportunity to reaffirm Idaho's support for sustainable livestock grazing, balanced public use, and collaboration among pastoralists, recreationalists, conservation partners, and land management agencies to ensure healthy working landscapes throughout the state.

1 NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED by the members of the Second Regular Ses-
2 sion of the Sixty-eighth Idaho Legislature, the Senate and the House of Rep-
3 resentatives concurring therein, that the Legislature recognizes and sup-
4 ports Governor Little's proclamation recognizing 2026 as the International
5 Year of Rangelands and Pastoralists.

6 BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the Legislature of the State of Idaho sup-
7 ports the 2026 International Year of Rangelands and Pastoralists and the ef-
8 forts made by the associated global and regional alliances and groups.

9 BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the Legislature recognizes the importance
10 of national policies on conservation and sustainable use of natural re-
11 sources in order to manage grazing areas, wildlife, water sources, livestock
12 movement, risk, and resilience and to enable land use planning and ecosystem
13 management by pastoralists and relevant public entities.